

Mon., July 13, 2026: BWNA Board Meeting Agenda
Sylvan Learning Center, 4300 N.E. Fremont St. (or via Zoom)

Roll Call and Introductions (President Al Ellis presiding)

Introduction of **Board members and non-Board member committee chairs:**

Board Members: Al Ellis, President, Tim Gillespie, Vice-President, Karla Lenox, Treasurer, Patti Koehler, Secretary. Patty Nelson, Immediate Past President. At Large Board Members, John Sandie, Aaron Breakstone, Angela Frome, Susan Trabucco, Rob Lee, Tim Root, David Knowles, Crystal Grainger. Non-Board Member Committee Chairs: Mary Roney, Friends of Wilshire Park Committee, Graeme Rudd, Transportation Committee, Steve Avery (elected this evening to replace Matt Granger), Communication Committee Chair. Board Members with **excused absences:** Tom Cuppernull, Colin O'Neill.

Guests: Peggy Ellis, Liz via Zoom

Association Meeting and Governance Items (Board member-only voting)

Approval of agenda (Al): Patti moved, Tim G seconded, unanimously approved.

Approval of minutes from June 8th General Meeting (Patti Koehler) As Amended, Karla moved, Crystal seconded, unanimously approved.

Speakers: NAYA's Sky Waters, Community Development Director at the Native American Youth and Family Center (NAYA), Paul Stromberg, Vice President of the Oregon Synod and David Eppelshelmer, Bishops Assistant to Bishop Lori Larson Caesar.—Bethany Lutheran (Al):

Paul Stromberg began the presentation stating that there are around 100 Lutheran Church congregations in Oregon which are all part of the Oregon Synod. Bethany Lutheran Church decided to close and they asked the Synod for help in deciding what to do with the property. The Synod wanted to celebrate and honor the legacy of Bethany, which was founded in 1889 and moved to its current location in 1948 while being open to the possibilities of healing, health and rebirth. The Synod has been very involved in learning about land stories and histories. Traditionally there was a village on that land, a Chinookan village called Nuchokikuba which was there for hundreds or perhaps thousands of years. The building is in very poor repair, which was a consideration. The whole process took about 18 months, in July of 2025 the Synod came to a decision to investigate doing a land back process of some sort looking for an organization whose mission and values resonated with theirs as well as a partner that had both the capacity and vision to hold the land and take care of it. NAYA was their choice, NAYA has been very involved in the neighborhood and they have multiple buildings and experience in that area. The end of June, the Synod signed over the property to NAYA, making it a land back transaction with a closing process very similar to purchasing a normal home but there was no money exchanged.

Sky Waters shared a bit about NAYA. It was founded over 50 years ago by parent volunteers that were looking for a safe place their kids could play basketball, learn and be somewhere after school. Over the years different services have been added and now there are over 40 programs and services ranging from early childcare to an alternative high school. But the housing component is more recent, which is a big need in the native community. They have redeveloped three properties in the Cully neighborhood consisting of about 165 units. The Synod approached NAYA in December of 2025 and they went through a long process to decide if they wanted to accept the land, as it comes with some challenges. They are exploring elder housing as their number one option as they move forward, looking at the cottage cluster model where people can age in place, be with family and receive services. Currently working with their property management and asset management teams to secure the site, keeping the landscaping and outside area looking good. The next couple of weeks they move more into putting together a development plan and doing some fundraising. In answer to questions posed by the board, Sky reported that there is no intention to change zoning codes. They do

anticipate taking down the entire building and hope to preserve some of its historical artifacts if possible. The units will focus on elder housing but they will not provide healthcare. Marketing will go to elderly Native American's but they will be open to all applicants to comply with fair housing issues. They are looking at building 14-18 units. Sky noted that it is a long process to redevelop a property, if things go well, it can take anywhere from 12-36 months. They have secured the property with cameras and alarms, please call if an alarm goes off. They are drafting a letter for the neighbors and will share contact information with them and us. Going forward they will come back and share updates when there is anything new to share. Appreciation was expressed by Al and other members of the Board for the current presentation and future updates. Susan verified there will be an article in the upcoming newsletter regarding these recent developments.

Treasurer's Report (Karla Lenox): As of June 30th, the end of our fiscal year.

- a.) cash in checking account: \$29,511.83
- b.) cash in Venmo account: \$202.40
- c.) outstanding bills: \$2022 for the July/August newsletter. \$200.50 to Susan for Art and Garden Posters.

NECN (Northeast Coalition of Neighborhoods): **Vote: term extension for Patty Nelson** (Al)

Patty reported Crystal will take her place but NECN delayed the election until September. Patty will remain until after elections. Patty missed the last meeting due to surgery but Crystal attended it and reported that they voted on their 2027 agenda. Over the past couple of months they have been working with an outside consulting group and everything looks to be on track. The last meeting was very concise, which hasn't been the case in the past for the ones she has attended. They started building out what they are calling the NECN's pillars, which are their pillars of operation and they were open to lots of feedback and questions. A rep from NECN will be attending one of our upcoming meetings and Crystal expressed a desire to hear more about their way of addressing diversity, equity and inclusion because the way they presented it was very eloquent and she thought we could learn from that.

Board Retreat: venue = Mule? Kennedy School? Other? Date = a Saturday in November? (Al): Al reported we have \$350 to spend, if we have the retreat at the Mule Bar there is no charge and money can be used for food and NA refreshments. He will send out an email regarding dates for November.

BWNA \$ sponsorship for Positive Aging Health & Wellness Fair in Oct.? (Angela Frome): Oct. 10th from 11-3:00 at the German American Society. They are expecting about 500 people. Angie shared the levels of sponsorship. Patty made a motion that we contribute \$500 as a Neighborhood Supporter, Susan seconded. Following discussion the motion passed unanimously. Susan also reported that there will be an article in the September/October newsletter interviewing Libby, who is the director of The Center for Positive Aging. Our \$500 sponsorship would provide an information table at the event and supporter logo recognition in their newsletter and flyers.

Upcoming Speakers: Counsilar Elana Pirtle-Guiney = Aug. 10; NET leader Bec Lawson = Sept. 14

Outstanding Action Items/Committee Updates (Board member-only voting)

Vote: Steve Avery for Communication Committee Chair (Al)/ **ComCom report** (Steve): Steve reported the committee has been working on an update to the BWNA website. He gave a demo of it to Susan and Al last week. It is getting really close to being ready to go live pending some design changes that Susan and Jane are working on. In August or September it will be presented to the Board with the recommendation that we switch to the new website, using the GitHub platform.

Beaumont Middle School beautification initiative (Angela Frome): Tim got in touch with the Principal who said we just had to sign release forms to work on the grounds. 7/3 six volunteers came and worked for 2.5 hours. Took 13 tall bags of weeds out of the front bed. Mike the Bike guy stopped by and helped out, he hoped to put the article in The Star newsletter but they didn't accept it. Joan Meyerhoff (who came to our last board meeting) would like to explore future opportunities with BMS so we will see what can happen. So much there that needs to be done.

Friends of Wilshire Park Committee (Mary Roney): Mary was asked if people can drive into the park. She explained that some people have permits but sometimes people go who don't. She will raise the issue with Violet, our connection at the Portland Parks Bureau. She expressed thanks to Karla for walking the perimeter and picking up garbage. Lots of kid camps are happening at the park right now. Also bike rides, yoga, golfing, fly fishing practice and foam ball golf games. The Parks Department is working on creating a new nature space plaque as the old one got ruined by graffiti and they put new bark chips in the dog park which still needs to be spread. Working on doing a Friends of Wilshire Park kind of initial launch meeting but Mary reports it's usually John, Al and herself, so sometimes she doesn't feel a need to do a meeting. However, through the website we've got about five people interested in joining and being on the volunteer committee. Patty asked about the possibility of a splash pad, Mary replied that it is not on their radar as it is very expensive and the parks department doesn't want to do it because it comes back to their equity foundation and we are not far from the Fern Hill splash pad.

Events Committee (John Sandie): John spoke about the good turnout for the Yard Sale that happened this past weekend. The Art and Garden tour is happening this coming Saturday, as of today Susan reported 104 tickets have been purchased. Movie in the Park is August 13th, we will have a booth and try to do a 50/50 raffle. The block party is Sept 11th. Will have the same food carts and will continue to have the kids zone. The Missoula Floods speaker will be Oct. 29th. Al discussed Fremont Fest occurring on 8/1: we have eight volunteers to cover four shifts. Planning meeting at his house 7/16 at 4:30. He requested a booth near the Plaza but won't know until a couple of days before.

Newsletter Team (Susan Trabucco): Al read a letter from Seth Groener thanking the newsletter group for everything they do to keep the neighborhood informed. "There is not an issue that goes by that I don't learn multiple new things about the place we have lived in for over a decade." The one thing he did recommend was a new recurring feature might be an article written by kids for kids. Susan said we had someone briefly but would be open to anyone willing. Mary stated she might have someone that could be good, a young woman who raised money for Wilshire Park unbeknownst even to her mother.

Susan reported the next issue will be all color but we won't have to pay for the extra color due to the printing mix up previously reported. She reminded people that August 1st is the due date for ads/information for events happening in October (for the Sept/Oct newsletter). She asked Angie if the Center for Positive Aging could get an ad to her that would include our logo. Patti asked Steve if he could send an email out reminding people that Art and Garden is happening next week and he agreed to do so.

Transportation Committee (Graeme Rudd): Graeme was unanimously voted in as our new Transportation Committee Chair: He has reached out to our PBOT contact to establish a relationship with them.. Also connected with someone from PBOT at the Plaza's Grand Opening. His biggest initiative now is trying to collect as much information and data about what are the problems in the neighborhood, such as parking. Graeme was informed by Patty that we have had

meetings specific to transportation issues and reports are available, she volunteered to see if she can find them. When asked about an extra parking spot near the plaza for Green Dog he replied that they were going to be for deliveries in general, not just for Green Dog and that they did add in the one hour parking limitation. Susan reported that Andy from Blackbird Wine has painted a yellow space for where the dumpster should be but that the last food cart was parked there now. Patty replied he is painting it yellow because the dumpster is not getting emptied like it is supposed to be and trash is overflowing causing rats to come. Graeme asked for any and all information relating to transportation to be sent to him.

Beaumont Crossing Ad Hoc Committee (Aaron): Aaron asked for any Plaza specific problems to connect with him. The Plaza opening moved quickly. They had to wait for PBOT to get the painting scheduled. The furniture there now outside of the picnic tables is temporary and there will be more furniture coming in a few weeks. The painting event was very successful. They had a concert Thursday 7/9 by Red Yarn which was really well attended. Fremont Garage paid for the picnic tables close to them. There is a 10 foot strip from the curb that those tables are in, they are open to anyone, not just Fremont Garage patrons. BBA is doing a lot of advertising for the Plaza. We are still working on getting our communications out there. Anybody can schedule an event in the plaza. There's a link where you can submit an application on the PBOT page. We are not the gatekeepers but they will check with Mary and Aaron to make sure that are no conflicts. There is an email address at plaza@bwnapdx.org if people have questions.

Land Use (Tim Root); Planning Commission: "missing middle zoning" (David Knowles) Tim stated he has no real report, just monitoring the city council meeting agendas. He is anticipating The Inner East Side Report to come out some time this summer. David reported that the City council will direct the bureau to start a zoning project which will require a bunch of public meetings and then it will eventually come back to the planning commission, but that won't be for a year and a half. Patti encouraged Board members to bring up any concerns to Elana when she is at our Board meeting next month.

Crime & Safety (Patty); **pedestrian crosswalk flags** (Angela & Patti): Angela reported the flags have been staying put. Other neighborhoods have been putting up flags also. There is no additional information regarding Beaumont Market and they have not responded to any of our emails..

New Neighbor Welcoming Project—new contact at First American Title; 15 to greet (Al): Please pick up any you wish to distribute.

8:30-8:35: For The Good Of The Order (announcements, meeting reflections, etc.)
Upcoming General Meeting = Mon., Aug. 10, 2026, 7:00 p.m., Sylvan Learning Center

Adjournment: 8:40